

THE TABLE

TEXT: Matthew 15:21-28 (NKJV) "Then Jesus went out from there and departed to the region of Tyre and Sidon.²² And behold, a woman of Canaan came from that region and cried out to Him, saying, "Have mercy on me, O Lord, Son of David! My daughter is severely demon-possessed."²³ But He answered her not a word. And His disciples came and urged Him, saying, "Send her away, for she cries out after us."²⁴ But He answered and said, "**I was not sent except to the lost sheep of the house of Israel.**"²⁵ Then she came and worshiped Him, saying, "Lord, help me!"²⁶ But He answered and said, "**It is not good to take the children's bread and throw it to the little dogs.**"²⁷ And she said, "Yes, Lord, yet even the little dogs eat the crumbs which fall from their masters' table."²⁸ Then Jesus answered and said to her, "**O woman, great is your faith! Let it be to you as you desire.**" And her daughter was healed from that very hour."

INTRO: The Word of God has much to say about hunger both physical and spiritual. Much to do is made in Scripture about;

- How to treat the widows

- How to treat the orphans
- How to treat the poor

There is something about hunger both physically and spiritually that moves the hand of God.

If you want to get God's attention, minister to the hungry or become hungry (this might be better defined as desperate). God responds to hunger or desperation!

Look at our text...

I. THIS WOMAN HAS A DESPERATE SITUATION!

Listen to the desperation. Matthew 15:21-22 (NKJV) **"Then Jesus went out from there and departed to the region of Tyre and Sidon.22 And behold, a woman of Canaan came from that region and cried out to Him, saying, “Have mercy on me, O Lord, Son of David! My daughter is severely demon-possessed.”**"

Jesus handles this situation in a very uncharacteristic manner. Matthew 15:23 (NKJV) **"But He answered her not a word."**

Desperate people often feel as if they are being ignored!

II. THE DISCIPLES ATTEMPT TO REMOVE THE WOMAN!

The plan of the disciples is to get rid of her!

Jesus makes note of the fact that she is not who He was sent to minister to! Matthew 5:23-24 (NKJV) "**And His disciples came and urged Him, saying, “Send her away, for she cries out after us.”**"²⁴ But He answered and said, **“I was not sent except to the lost sheep of the house of Israel.”**

Hungry people are often ostracized by the church! Out of site, out of mind!

We do this as if to say, if we ignore the desperation of the world long enough will it go away!

We are often guilty of defining who we want to minister to in such narrow terms that we fail to minister to a very large segment of the population!

III. THE WOMAN WORSHIPS IN AN ATTEMPT TO GET WHAT SHE NEEDS!

Matthew 15:25 (NKJV) "**Then she came and worshiped Him, saying, “Lord, help me!”**"

Worship is always a good way to get Gods attention! Someone said *"When all else fails,*

worship!" I say, "Worship and you may not need to try anything else!"

IV. JESUS CALLS THE WOMAN A DOG!

Matthew 15:26 (NKJV) "**But He answered and said, “It is not good to take the children’s bread and throw it to the little dogs.”**

Jesus calls this woman a dog!

The words of Jesus do not even seem to register on this lady! She was hungry; desperate; Jesus is probably her last resort!

Listen to the words of this woman... Matthew 15:27 (NKJV) "**And she said, “Yes, Lord, yet even the little dogs eat the crumbs which fall from their masters’ table.”**

(Bring in the staff and talk about hunger)

(Bring Angel in and talk about the insignificance of a dog)

(Explain why the staff is not hungry)

(Feed angel crumbs - A desperate, hungry person will not even recognize they have been insulted! They are focused on what they need to receive!)

Listen to the words of Jesus! Matthew 15:28
(NKJV) "Then Jesus answered and said to
her, **"O woman, great is your faith! Let it be
to you as you desire."** And her daughter was
healed from that very hour."

V. HOW HUNGRY ARE YOU?

These words were spoken through the virgin
Mary when she was visiting Elizabeth the
mother of John the Baptist. Luke 1:53 (NKJV)
**"He has filled the hungry with good things,
And the rich He has sent away empty."**

Listen to how hungry the Psalmist was...Psalm
42:1 (NKJV) **"As the deer pants for the water
brooks, So pants my soul for You, O God."**

Psalm 63:1-8 (NKJV) **"A Psalm of David
when he was in the wilderness of Judah. 1 O
God, You *are* my God; Early will I seek You;
My soul thirsts for You; My flesh longs for
You In a dry and thirsty land Where there is
no water. 2 So I have looked for You in the
sanctuary, To see Your power and Your
glory. 3 Because Your lovingkindness is
better than life, My lips shall praise You. 4
Thus I will bless You while I live; I will lift
up my hands in Your name. 5 My soul shall
be satisfied as with marrow and fatness, And
my mouth shall praise You with joyful lips. 6**

When I remember You on my bed, I
meditate on You in the *night* watches. 7
Because You have been my help, Therefore
in the shadow of Your wings I will rejoice. 8
My soul follows close behind You; Your
right hand upholds me."

Matthew 5:6 (NKJV) "**Blessed *are* those who
hunger and thirst for righteousness, For they
shall be filled."**